

Napster had all their servers located at a single location in Silicon Valley, CA. MetaMachine, though, went the opposite direction and released their server software in the community. It was akin to letting salt dissolve in water with the water being the P2P community. Now it became the community's responsibility to take care of the server and update it with the latest information to attract more users to use the software. MetaMachine develops the technology, but it is the responsibility of the community to maintain the network.

The eDonkey network requires some maintenance for operating at optimum levels. First, every user needs to install the eDonkey2000 client and then download the server.met file from a specified website. This file contains the latest information of all the servers available and provides server address to the client software so that it can connect to faster and live servers.

Once that is done, the client makes a connection with a server and gets connected to the network. Now you can use the integrated search box in the client to search for whatever you want ranging from applications to movies to albums to just about anything.

Other applications that are modified eDonkey2000 clients and utilising the same network are eMule, Shareaza, aMule, eMule plus, Morpheus and many more for the Windows platform. For Macs, you can use software such as hydranode, iSwine and of course eMule and aMule versions for Macs. Similar clients are also available for Linux.

The eDonkey network set the standard for hashing files. What is file hashing? Hashing is the transformation of a string of characters into a usually shorter fixed-length value or key that represents the original string. Hashing is used to index and retrieve items in a database because it is faster to find the item using the shorter hashed key than to find it using the original value. So, if you have a database of Digit magazines consisting of records of articles from June 2001 to July 2005, trying to access data by typ-